

app itself. The move is directed towards extending Google's multi-billion dollar advertising business to the smartphones territory.

Google's ad revenue has been down in the dumps owing to the fact that more and more consumers access its online services on mobile devices, where advertising rates are far lower when compared to PCs. Google is finding it difficult to profit, even as mobile apps mushroom every now and then providing ample information to users—right from restaurant reviews to online games. Earlier, Google had begun to offer 'deep linking' capabilities with a limited number of participating mobile apps.

With this latest move, marketers can provide a direct pathway into their apps from the search ads. They can then display ads that they actually run on original Google sites. The new feature will initially appear only on smartphones running on Android and is expected to be available in the next few months.

OnePlus One with CyanogenMod 11s launched

Chinese smartphone startup, OnePlus, has finally launched its first smartphone. The OnePlus 'One' will be available at an introductory price of US\$ 299 (unlocked, without contract) for the 16 GB model (roughly Rs 18,300). The 64 GB variant will be available at US\$ 349 (roughly Rs 21,350). The One will come up with some real over-the-top specs. Let's have a look.

The OnePlus One will feature a 13.97-cm (5.5-inch) IPS LCD display with a 1080x1920 pixel resolution and Coming Gorilla Glass 3 protection. It will be powered by a 2.5 GHz quad-core Qualcomm Snapdragon 801 processor with an Adreno 330 GPU coupled with 3 GB of RAM. The device will run CyanogenMod 11S, a customised OS based on Android 4.4 KitKat. It will sport a 13 MP rear IMX214 sensor camera and a 5 MP front-facing camera. The device will not support any expandable storage. Connectivity options include 4G LTE, Wi-Fi 802.11 a/b/g/n/ac, Bluetooth 4.0 and NFC. It will have a 3100 mAh non-removable battery.

The OnePlus One will be initially available in Austria, Belgium, Canada, Denmark, Finland, France, Germany, Hong Kong, Italy, the Netherlands, Portugal, Spain, Sweden, Taiwan, the UK and the US.

Here's a Tor-powered Linux device that you can simply plug in to become snoop-proof!

Kay Anar and Gilad Shai, both long time TechCrunch Disrupt NY hackathon participants, have come up with a new device that you can just plug into the back of your computer to secure your connection from snooping. The duo recently demonstrated their hardware hack—the oRouter.

The oRouter is a Raspberry Pi-like computer that is powered by Linux and offers secure Wi-Fi access via the Tor network. The Tor-powered Linux device is an affordable alternative to actually downloading Tor. The oRouter is also an effective way to easily connect to the Tor network over mobile devices like Apple's iPhone, for instance. The demonstrated version supports up to 32 simultaneous connections. The oRouter consists of off-the-shelf components like a low-power single board computer, courtesy Texas Instruments, and low-power USB Wi-Fi dongles. Also, it requires just 5 V of power to operate.

Meet Cloudsto EVO, the inexpensive Linux Mini PC

Mini PC specialist Cloudsto is reportedly adding a new, small, low power Linux PC to its portfolio. Dubbed the Cloudsto EVO, this is a palm-sized computer, which will be powered by an ARM Cortex-A9 quad core processor and Ubuntu 12.10 software.

This is the first ARM mini PC that will have a VGA port instead of Ethernet. In addition, it will also provide support for typical PC display resolutions and an Ethernet jack, all designed so as to make the system a completely functional PC. According to reports, the Cloudsto EVO will be selling at US\$ 160 in the United States.

Powered by a 1.6 GHz Rockchip RK3188 processor along with ARM Mali 400 graphics, the EVO has 1 GB of RAM and 8 GB of internal storage. It has micro-SD card support and Wi-Fi connectivity.

While this PC will be much slower than most other Linux-based variants, it uses much less power (only about 2-5 Watts) and is cheaper than others.

Linux Mint to be based solely on Ubuntu LTS

New releases of Linux-based distribution Linux Mint will reportedly be based on the Ubuntu LTS. According to reports, Clement Lefebvre, founder of Linux Mint, has announced that starting immediately, Linux Mint 17 (Qiana) will be based only on the LTS releases.

According to reports, this will reduce the complexity in going from version 17 to 17.1, 17.2 and so on. Also, fewer releases of the distro would mean that more effort would go into the development of the same package base over the next two years.

Clement also said that users will not need to sacrifice the latest updates of important applications, which will be backported to suit their needs.

